Chinese poliothyrsis (Chinese pearlbloom)

Poliothyrsis sinensis

Family: Not stated Also known as: —

GARDENS Overlook: 2 **TOTAL 2**



Summer / form
Library candidate

Not available

Fall color
Not available

Not available

Flower
Not available



Leaf close-up
Library candidate

QUICK FACTS & PLANTING

Type: Tree
Evergreen/Deciduous: Deciduous
Mature size: 30–40 ft (to ~15 m / ~49 ft in some references) × 15–25 ft
Hardiness / Zone 8a: Hardy in USDA zones 6–9 (including 8a and 8b). Native to central and southern China. Suitable for Atlanta Zone 8a. Not stated for specific Atlanta performance beyond zone range.
Sun: Full sun to partial shade
Water: Medium; drought tolerant once established.
Soil: Rich, medium moisture, well-drained; adapts to various soils.
Growth rate: Medium.
Not stated
Planting:
Siting: (Care / planting pass): Plant at grade in full sun to partial shade in rich, medium-moisture, well-drained soils. Tolerates part shade. Established trees have drought tolerance. Pruning: minimal; remove wayward or crossing shoots in late winter or early spring. First-year irrigation: Not stated in detail beyond general establishment. Mulch depth, mound vs level, soil amendment: Not stated.
Soil prep: Rich, medium moisture, well-drained; adapts to various soils.
Depth/spacing: Not stated
Season: Not stated
Establishment: Not stated

ORIGIN, CHARACTERISTICS & HEALTH

Origin / native: Native to central and southeastern China (Anhui, Fujian, southern Gansu, Guangdong, Guizhou, Henan, Hubei, Hunan, Jiangsu, Jiangxi, southern Shaanxi, Sichuan, northeastern Yunnan, Zhejiang). Forests at 400–1500 m. First discovered in China by Augustine Henry (Hubei, ~1888–1889). Seed introduced to the West by E. H. Wilson (~1901–1909). [Trees and Shrubs Online; Missouri Botanical Garden; POWO]
Form / habit: Small deciduous tree, upright to spreading, open habit.
Foliage: Yellow / attractive yellow.
Flowers / fruit: Fragrant, petal-less, pearl-like white buds opening to creamy-white/greenish-white in large panicles (to 8 in) in summer (August–September).
Bark / stem: Gray-brown, furrowed on mature trees.
Not stated
Health:
Health notes: (Health / infestation pass): None known / No serious problems stated. Missouri Botanical Garden: No serious insect or disease problems. RHS and Trees and Shrubs Online: generally pest-free / disease-free / trouble-free. No specific Atlanta or Zone 8a pest notes found.